# Comparing Groups of Objects: More, Fewer, and the Same Answer Key

Kindergarten–Grade 1

**Quick Answers**

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1. — | 3. 3 | 5. 3 | 7. 4 |
| 2. — | 4. — | 6. 4, 6, 9 | 8. 5 |

**Curriculum**

**Level:** Kindergarten–Grade 1
K.CC.A.1–K.CC.C.7 – *problems 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8*
*Difficulty 1–4 of 5 across 8 tagged checks.*

## 1. Amy's stars vs. Ben's dots.

**Solution:** Count Amy's row by touching each star: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5. Count Ben's row: 1, 2, 3. Now match one star to one dot. Ben's row runs out after three matches and Amy still has two stars with no partner, so Amy's group has more. Amy's row is the one to circle. The symbol opens toward the bigger number, so the comparison reads $\boxed{5 > 3}$.

## 2. Apples and baskets.

**Solution:** There are 4 apples and 4 baskets. Draw the matching lines: every apple gets a basket and every basket gets an apple, so neither row runs out first and neither row has leftovers. Two groups that match exactly one to one are the same, and the comparison reads $\boxed{4 = 4}$.
*Watch for:* a child who writes $>$ or $<$ here is choosing a symbol by habit rather than by matching — ask them to point to a leftover object. There isn't one.

## 3. 7 frogs and 4 lily pads — how many more frogs?

**Solution:** Count the frogs: 7. Count the lily pads: 4. Match one frog to one pad and cross those frogs out; 4 frogs get crossed out. Count the frogs still without a pad: 1, 2, 3. Those three are the extra frogs, which is what "how many more" asks for. The subtraction sentence for the picture is $7 - 4 = 3$, so the number of extra frogs is $\boxed{3}$.
*Watch for:* an answer of 11 means the child added the two rows. "How many more" compares the rows, so the two numbers are taken apart, not put together.

## 4. Red cubes vs. blue cubes.

**Solution:** Count the red row: 6. Count the blue row: 8. Match them one to one: the red row runs out first, with two blue cubes left unmatched. The row that runs out first has fewer, so the red row is the one to circle. Writing the smaller number first, the comparison reads $\boxed{6 < 8}$.

### 5. Nina picks 9 flowers, Omar picks 6 — how many fewer?

**Solution:** The two rows of dots should line up so that each of Omar's 6 dots sits under one of Nina's dots. Six of Nina's dots have a partner and the rest do not. Count the unpartnered dots: 1, 2, 3. Omar picked three fewer flowers, which is the same comparison as saying Nina picked three more. The subtraction sentence is $9 - 6 = 3$, so the answer is $\boxed{3}$.

*Watch for:* an answer of 9 means the child read the bigger row instead of the leftover part of it.

### 6. Ordering Cup A, Cup B, and Cup C.

**Solution:** Count each cup: Cup A has 6 marbles, Cup B has 9 marbles, and Cup C has 4 marbles. To order them, ask which cup runs out first when matched against the others. Cup C runs out first, so it is the fewest. Cup B has leftovers against both of the others, so it is the most, and Cup A sits between them. From fewest to most the counts are $\boxed{4,\ 6,\ 9}$ — that is Cup C, then Cup A, then Cup B.

### 7. Sam has 5 shells, Kim has 9 — how many more does Sam need?

**Solution:** Lining the rows up one to one, 5 of Kim's shells are matched and the rest are not. Count up from 5 to 9 — "6, 7, 8, 9" — which is four counts, so four of Kim's shells have no partner. Giving Sam that many shells fills every empty spot and the two rows match exactly. Check the sentence: $5 + 4 = 9$ ✓. Sam needs $\boxed{4}$ more shells.

### 8. Challenge — Lee has 4 stickers, Jo has 9.

**Solution:** Draw 4 dots for Lee and 9 dots for Jo, lined up one under the other. Four of Jo's stickers are matched to Lee's, and the unmatched ones are the gap Lee has to close. Count up from 4 to 9: "5, 6, 7, 8, 9" is five counts, so five of Jo's dots have no partner. Check the sentence: $4 + 5 = 9$ ✓. Lee must get $\boxed{5}$ more stickers.

*Grading the explanation:* accept any wording that points at the unmatched dots, e.g. "Jo has five dots with nobody under them, so Lee needs five more." The explanation is scored on the matching idea, not on spelling.